Bristol Youth Voice Network

Key Questions

- What approaches to youth leadership and governance are working in your organisation? What can others learn from them?
- What issues are important to the young people you're working with?
- What projects are you working on related to those issues/ what young people have highlighted?
- Are there common themes across Bristol?
- How do we use and share the information we are hearing from young people?
- How do we make sure young people are meaningfully involved, rather than simply consulted?

What approaches to youth leadership and governance are working in your organisation? What can others learn from them?

What's Working

- Young leader programmes
- Youth boards
- Regular check-ins with young people
- Focus groups and surveys
- Co-design and co-production
- Young people shaping projects and services
- Building relationships through 1:1 conversations

What We've Learnt

- Involve young people from the start
- Build strong relationships
- Give young people ownership
- Feed back on what has changed

What issues are important to the young people you're working with?

Key Issues

- Mental health and wellbeing
- Online safety and bullying
- Poverty and cost of living
- Racism, inequality and discrimination
- Loneliness and isolation
- Accessibility and inclusion
- Community safety
- Healthy relationships
- Climate anxiety
- AI and future employment
- Careers, work experience and job security
- Exam pressure
- Independence and transitions into adulthood

What projects are you working on related to those issues/ what young people have highlighted?

Examples of Current Work

- Youth leadership programmes
- Youth boards and governance groups
- Consultation activities
- Focus groups and surveys
- Work experience support
- Mental health and wellbeing projects
- Community development planning
- Creative content and communications projects
- Digital engagement and online consultations

Are there common themes across Bristol?

Common Themes

- Young people want more opportunities
- Young people want to be listened to
- Safety is a major concern
- Mental health remains a priority
- Inclusion and accessibility matter
- Young people are concerned about their future
- More support is needed around belonging and connection

How do we use and share the information we are hearing from young people?

How We Gather Information

- Surveys
- Focus groups
- 1:1 conversations
- Youth groups
- Workshops and away days
- Key working reports
- Digital engagement

- How We Use It
- Identify common themes
- Share learning across organisations
- Inform planning and decision-making
- Improve services and projects
- Influence future work

How do we make sure young people are meaningfully involved, rather than simply consulted?

- Meaningful Participation
- Involved from the beginning
- Helping shape decisions
- Helping design projects and services
- Seeing what changed afterwards
- Being recognised as experts by experience
- Having real responsibility
- Being involved in ways that work for them

Consultation → Co-Design → Co-Production

Consultation

- Young people give their views

Co-Design

- Young people help shape projects and services

Co-Production

- Young people share ownership and decision-making throughout the process

Goal

- Move beyond consultation wherever possible

Key Reflections

- What We Heard
- Similar issues are being raised across Bristol
- Safety, wellbeing, opportunity and inclusion are recurring themes
- Young people want genuine influence, not token involvement
- Feedback should lead to visible action
- Participation works best when it is ongoing and embedded
- Reflection Question
- How can we work together to turn young people's voices into real change?

Thank you

BRISTOL YOUTH VOICE NETWORK

https://www.bristolyouthvoice.com/